LINTEL FIELD GUIDE · 01

The kitchen hardware checklist
20 checks before you sign off a modular kitchen

A modular kitchen is sold on the shutter and fails on the hinge. The shutter is what you see in the showroom. The hinge, the channel and the carcass are what you use forty times a day for ten years. **Take this sheet to every vendor meeting and tick what they can show you, in writing.**

A Hinges

- [ ] **Brand and model stamped on the hinge arm.** If the vendor says "imported" or "German type" without a name, it is not a brand.
- [ ] **Soft-close built into the hinge cup,** not a clip-on damper added afterwards. Clip-ons loosen within a year.
- [ ] **Three-way adjustable (height, depth, side).** This is what keeps shutter gaps even after the kitchen settles.
- [ ] **Cycle rating in writing.** Good brands publish a tested figure. Ask for it on the quote, not verbally.

B Drawer channels

- [ ] **Full-extension channels on every drawer.** Three-quarter extension hides the back 25 % of the drawer forever.
- [ ] **Load rating stated per drawer type.** Cutlery drawers and pot drawers need different ratings. One number for all is a red flag.
- [ ] **Undermount or tandem box, not bottom-mount roller.** Roller channels are the cheapest part in the catalogue and the first to go.
- [ ] **Drawer box material named.** Steel-sided box systems and ply boxes behave differently with weight and moisture. Know which you are buying.

C Tall units and overheads

- [ ] **Lift-up fitting matched to the shutter weight.** A lift-up rated for a light shutter on a heavy one will not stay open.
- [ ] **Pull-out baskets and tall-unit fittings by brand.** Wire baskets are where "same look, half the price" usually hides.
- [ ] **Shelf support and back-panel thickness specified.** Overheads carry crockery for years. Ask what holds the shelf and what thickness the back is.

D Carcass and edges

- [ ] **Plywood grade written per cabinet.** Sink base and under-hob units need moisture-resistant grade. The rest can differ. One grade for all is either over- or under-specified.
- [ ] **Carcass thickness and back-panel thickness on the quote.** Not “standard”. A number.
- [ ] **Edge banding thickness on fronts, and machine-applied.** Hand-pressed banding peels at the corners first.
- [ ] **Skirting material that can take a mop.** Laminate on ply at floor level swells. Ask what sits at the floor line.

E Sink, hob and services

- [ ] **Sink base cabinet treated for water, inside and at the edges.** This is the cabinet that fails first in most Bengaluru kitchens.
- [ ] **Chimney duct route drawn before carcasses are made.** A duct planned after the overheads are built costs you a cabinet.
- [ ] **Appliance power points marked on the drawing.** Hob, chimney, oven, RO, dishwasher. Each one, with a position.

F Paperwork

- [ ] **Hardware brand and model listed line by line in the quote.** If it is a lump sum per square foot, you cannot compare two quotes and you cannot check what arrived.
- [ ] **Warranty terms in writing: hardware, carcass, and who services it.** Years for each, and a phone number that answers.
- [ ] **Installer named.** Is the person fitting your kitchen on the studio's payroll, or a sub-contractor you will never meet again?

How this works at Lintel

Every quote names the hardware brand and model per cabinet. Design and installation are one team on one contract, and the project executive is on your site every day. Post-handover support answers within 48 hours, and we come back once a year to check the kitchen.

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YRS JOINERY	YRS HARDWARE	YRS ELECTRICAL

Bring this sheet to the experience centre. We will go through it on a real kitchen.

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